



FOLUB & SAMUEL LABS

Company Handbook

Purpose, mission, vision, values, priorities and positioning.
Everything you need to understand FSLabs, onboard into it,
and defend it in a room.

LAGOS, NIGERIA · RC **9637480** · **FSLABS.TECH**
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How to use this document

This handbook exists to make three specific things possible.

1. Onboarding. A new team member should be able to read this and understand what FSLabs is, why it exists, how it earns, how work gets judged, and what is expected of them, without a founder having to explain it verbally.

2. Representing the company. Every one of us will at some point be asked "so what does FSLabs actually do?" or "why should we use you instead of a bigger firm?" Part IV gives you the answers. You should be able to defend this company in a room with no founder present.

3. Content and commercial planning. Our content strategist needs to know what we stand for, who we are talking to, what we sound like, and what we are pushing on, before they can build a plan. Parts III and IV are written for that.

Two companion documents. The **Staff Policy** ([STAFF_POLICY.md](#)) covers hours, leave, pay, client data rules, ownership of work, and what to do when something goes wrong. Read it alongside this one. The **partnership brief** covers the organisations we met at the summit.

On the priorities in Part III. They state what we are pushing on and who owns each one, without target figures. The direction is settled. The numbers attached to each priority are reviewed by the founders quarterly and communicated separately, so this handbook stays accurate as those targets move.

PART I: WHO WE ARE

1. FSLabs at a glance

LEGAL NAME	FOLUB AND SAMUEL LABS
Short form	FSLabs, one word. Never "FS Labs".
RC number	9637480
Incorporated	Nigeria
Base	Lagos, Nigeria
Website	https://fslabs.tech
Email	folubandsamuel@fslabs.tech
Founders	Adeseko Samuel (technical) and Akinbayo (business)
Tagline	Your Vision. Our Execution.
What we are	A technology and cybersecurity company
How we earn	Client services, our own products, the Academy

2. Why FSLabs exists

Every company has a founding frustration. Ours is about delivery.

Nigerian businesses that need software have two bad options. They hire a large firm and become a small account, where the senior people who won the pitch disappear after the kick off meeting, the work goes to whoever is available, and status meetings replace progress. Or they hire cheap and fast, and get something that demos well, breaks under real use, was never documented, and was never secured.

Both failures have the same root cause: **the people who promised the work are not the people who do it.**

FSLabs is built to remove that gap. Two founders, each technical enough and commercial enough to be accountable, on every single project. When a client engages us they get Adeseko Samuel on the technical side and Akinbayo on strategy and delivery. Every time. Nothing is handed off to junior contractors or offshore teams.

That is not a marketing position. It is the operating constraint we designed the company around, and it is why our process in section 7 looks the way it does.

Say this until it is natural: most technology firms sell you senior people and deliver junior ones. We only have senior people, and they are the ones on your project.

3. Vision

****To build and secure the systems Nigerian business runs on, and to train the engineers who will build the rest.****

Two halves, deliberately.

Build and secure the systems Nigerian business runs on. Not brochure websites. The systems a business cannot afford to have fail: payments, payroll, customer records, security posture. That is where trust is earned, and trust is the asset that compounds.

Train the engineers who will build the rest. The Academy is not a side business. It is how we grow past two founders without breaking the promise in section 2, and how we build a talent bench our competitors do not have.

4. Mission

****To be the bridge between technology and business: connecting companies to real talent, delivering world class tech services, and building products that matter.****

Read it as three commitments.

- 1. Connecting companies to real talent.** Through outsourcing and through the Academy. "Real" is the operative word: vetted, practising, accountable.
- 2. Delivering world class tech services.** World class means the standard does not drop because the client is in Lagos rather than London.
- 3. Building products that matter.** We ship our own products, and that is what proves the first two are true.

5. The standard

Everything we release has to **work, be documented, and be ready for the real world.**

If a piece of work fails any one of those three it is not finished, regardless of the deadline. This is the sentence to fall back on whenever you are unsure whether something is ready to hand over.

Samuel's version: everything we release has to actually work, scale, and be secure from day one. Security is not a phase at the end.

6. Values

Four values. They are not decoration. They are how work gets judged here. Each has a "looks like" and a "does not mean", because a value you cannot apply on a Tuesday afternoon is not a value.

01 Innovation

We don't follow trends. We set them. Every solution we build pushes the boundary of what is possible.

- **Looks like:** proposing the approach nobody asked for because it is genuinely better. Using new tooling where it earns its place. Building our own products instead of only billing hours.
- **Does not mean:** novelty for its own sake, or putting a client's production system on something unproven to satisfy our curiosity.

02 Ambition

We think big, move fast, and refuse to settle. Small thinking has no place here.

- **Looks like:** going after the enterprise client rather than the safe small one. Shipping weekly. Treating "that is how it is done in Nigeria" as a challenge rather than a limit.
- **Does not mean:** over committing on timelines. Ambition is about what we aim at, not what we promise a client on a call.

03 Integrity

We say what we mean and deliver what we promise. No fluff, no shortcuts, no excuses.

- **Looks like:** telling a client a date will slip the moment you know, not the week it is due. Scoping honestly even when it loses the deal. Admitting a mistake plainly and fixing it.
- **Does not mean:** bluntness as a personality. Integrity is about accuracy, not tone.

04 Impact

Technology is just a tool. What matters is what it changes, for our clients and for the world.

- **Looks like:** measuring the outcome rather than the output. Asking what a feature is actually for. Choosing the boring solution that solves the problem over the impressive one that does not.
- **Does not mean:** grand claims. Impact is specific, and usually small at first.

7. How we work: the process

Four stages, every engagement, no exceptions.

	STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS
01	Brief	The client tells us what they need. We listen, ask the right questions, and understand the real problem before touching a keyboard .
02	Scope	We define the work clearly. Realistic timelines. Honest deliverables. No scope creep, no surprises.
03	Build	We do the work. Software gets built, systems get secured, solutions get shipped. No status theatre .
04	Deliver	The client receives something that works, is documented, and is ready for the real world.

What this means daily

- **Understand before building.** Questions early are cheap. Rework is not.
- **Scope honestly.** If a timeline is not realistic, say so during Scope, not during Build.
- **No status theatre.** Report real progress, including problems. Bad news early is a service. Bad news late is a failure.
- **Document as you go.** Documentation is part of delivery, not an optional extra.
- **Secure from day one.** Not a phase at the end.
- **Respond within 24 hours.** That is the promise on our contact form. Honour it.

PART II: WHAT WE DO

8. Three business lines, one engine

FSLabs has three revenue lines. Understanding how they feed each other is the most important strategic idea in this document. It is why we are not simply an agency.

Services fund the company → **Products** prove we can build → back into **Services** credibility
Academy staffs Services, and Services credibility fills the Academy

- **Services fund the company.** Client revenue pays for everything else. This is the engine.
- **Products prove we can do it.** An agency says it can build a marketplace. We point at TailorNow. Products are our portfolio, our research, and eventually our recurring revenue.
- **The Academy supplies the talent** that lets services grow past two founders, and produces alumni who become hires, referrers and clients.
- **Each one makes the others believable.** A security firm that teaches ethical hacking is more credible. A training company whose instructors ship production systems is more credible. A product company that also consults understands business, not just code.

The strategic risk, said out loud: services revenue is the only line funding the others, and services capacity is capped by two founders. Everything in Part III is ultimately about relieving that constraint.

9. Service lines

Know these six. When someone asks what FSLabs does, this is the answer.

	LINE	IN ONE PHRASE	INCLUDES
01	Software Development	Custom built. Production ready.	Web and mobile apps, API development and integration, SaaS product development, legacy system modernisation
02	Cybersecurity	Protect what matters most.	Penetration testing and assessments, security audits and compliance, threat intelligence and monitoring, incident response and recovery
03	IT Consulting	Strategy meets execution.	Digital transformation strategy, technology roadmapping, IT infrastructure advisory, cloud architecture planning
04	Tech Outsourcing	Scale your team, not your costs.	Dedicated engineering teams, staff augmentation, project based outsourcing, DevOps and cloud management

LINE	IN ONE PHRASE	INCLUDES
05	Cloud Solutions	Modern infrastructure, built right.
06	Data & Analytics	Turn data into decisions.

Where the commercial weight sits. Cybersecurity and Tech Outsourcing are the two with the strongest recurring revenue shape. Security testing repeats on a cycle, and outsourced capacity bills monthly. Project software work pays well but ends. Bias the pipeline accordingly, and see Part III.

10. Products

PRODUCT	WHAT IT IS	WHY IT EXISTS
TailorNow (tailornow.shop)	Marketplace for custom fashion in Nigeria. Connects customers to verified tailors and creatives, and runs the whole order: discovery and portfolios, a style feed, booking, saved measurements, agreed pricing, payment with automatic split settlement to the creative, production tracking, fabric pickup and delivery, mutual ratings, disputes, plus group and aso ebi orders and corporate uniforms. 20% commission plus a 3% service charge.	Proves we can build and operate a real consumer marketplace with payments and logistics
HR & Payroll platform	Multitenant SaaS for Nigerian businesses: employees, departments, attendance, leave, documents, payroll records, audit logging, subscription billing.	Recurring revenue, and proves we can build enterprise grade software
FSLabs Exchange	Crypto to naira and account services. USDT, gift cards and related requests, processed within about 30 minutes.	Proves we can operate something with money, speed and trust attached

Handle with care: the HR platform holds employee personal data and salary records. It carries the highest data protection obligation of anything we run. Treat it accordingly, and see section 4 of the Staff Policy.

11. FSLabs Academy

We train people into real engineering roles, taught by **practising FSLabs engineers**, not career instructors. The Academy is also our talent pipeline: strong graduates are people we can hire and

place with clients.

TRACK	FOCUS	INTRODUCTORY PRICE
Full Stack Development	Frontend, backend, DevOps	₦180,000
Ethical Hacking Fundamentals	Cybersecurity, penetration testing	₦175,000
Machine Learning Foundations	AI, data science, Python	₦170,000
Backend Development	Servers, APIs, databases	₦160,000
Frontend Development	UI, React, responsive design	₦155,000
Prompt Engineering	AI tools, LLMs, automation	₦150,000

Introductory pricing is active. These are launch rates, discounted from standard pricing, with limited cohort sizes. We also run tailored individual and small group certification programmes, priced by goal.

Every student gets: live sessions, three or more portfolio projects they own, an FSLabs verified certificate, individual mentorship, session recordings, lifetime alumni community access, placement referrals and career guidance, and online first delivery with in person on request.

If you teach for the Academy: you are the product. The promise is instruction from people who actually ship, and portfolio projects good enough to get someone hired. Hold that line.

12. Who we serve

Four audiences. They want different things and need to be spoken to differently. This section is especially for the content strategist.

A. The medium to large Nigerian enterprise

Banks, fintechs, oil and gas, telecoms, manufacturing, government agencies.

- **They care about:** reliability, security, compliance, someone senior being accountable, not being embarrassed by a vendor.
- **Their fear:** picking a small firm and getting let down.
- **Lead with:** the accountability of both founders on the work, security credentials, our own products as evidence, and the documented delivery standard.
- **Buys:** cybersecurity assessments, custom software, consulting, outsourced capacity.

B. The growing Nigerian SME

Twenty to two hundred staff, digitising for the first time, moving off spreadsheets and WhatsApp.

- **They care about:** cost, speed, someone who explains things without condescension.
- **Their fear:** paying for something they do not understand and cannot maintain.
- **Lead with:** plain language, fixed honest scope, the HR and Payroll platform as an existing product they can start with, and our refusal to do status theatre.
- **Buys:** the HR platform subscription, small builds, cloud setup.

C. The Academy student

Career changers and new developers who want a job, not a certificate.

- **They care about:** whether this actually gets them hired.
- **Their fear:** paying for a bootcamp that teaches theory and then abandons them.
- **Lead with:** taught by engineers who ship, three or more portfolio projects you own, placement referrals, and the alumni network.
- **Buys:** a track, and then refers friends.

D. The partner

Payment providers, cloud and infrastructure providers, larger consultancies, investors.

- **They care about:** what we bring them. Volume, reach, capability, a category they cannot reach.
- **Lead with:** the offer before the ask. See [docs/partnerships/summit-partnership-brief.md](#).

Who we are not for

Saying this clearly protects the brand and saves everyone's time.

- Anyone shopping purely on lowest price. We are not the cheapest and should never pretend to be.
 - Anyone who wants a body shop that takes instructions without asking why.
 - Anyone who wants work done in a way we consider insecure or dishonest.
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PART III: WHERE WE ARE GOING

13. How we set priorities

One priority per business line, plus one for the company. Four in total, not twelve, so that everyone can remember them.

Each has a direction and a named owner. Target figures sit with the founders and are reviewed quarterly, so that this handbook does not go stale every time a number moves.

14. Our four priorities

Company: break the two founder ceiling

Owner: both founders.

Services capacity is capped by two people, and every other ambition depends on that changing. The work is to build capacity we can put in front of a client, made of Academy alumni, contractors and hires, without dropping the standard in section 5. Founder accountability on every project stays exactly as promised, even once the founders are not the ones typing.

Services: recurring revenue over one off projects

Owner: Akinbayo. Priority lines: Cybersecurity and Tech Outsourcing.

Move the shape of our revenue from project by project toward retainers and monthly contracts. These two lines are where that is possible: security testing repeats on a cycle, and outsourced capacity bills monthly. They are also the two that reinforce each other, because a security relationship is how you earn the trust that gets you the engineering contract.

Cybersecurity carries a second advantage worth stating: it is Samuel's own discipline, so it is the one line where our credibility needs no borrowing.

Academy: cohorts that produce staffable engineers

Owner: to be assigned by the founders.

Grow the cohorts, and treat **placement rather than enrolment** as the measure that matters. Enrolment is revenue. Placement is the promise. The Academy priority meets the company priority at exactly one point: alumni good enough to put on client work. That is the outcome to optimise for.

Products: from proof to paying

Owner: Samuel.

Get one product past the point of being a portfolio piece and into paying for itself. The HR and Payroll platform is the candidate, because subscription revenue is the only kind that compounds without selling more hours. TailorNow should be measured on one honest number rather than several flattering ones. FSLabs Exchange needs an explicit decision on whether it is a growth line or a maintained service, because ambiguity there costs attention.

15. The metrics that matter

Track few things, honestly.

LINE	THE ONE NUMBER	WHY THIS ONE
Services	Recurring revenue as a share of monthly cost	Tells you whether the company survives a slow month
Services	Proposal to close rate	Tells you whether the pitch or the pricing is the problem
Products	Paying subscriptions on the HR platform	The only product number that is not vanity
TailorNow	Completed orders per month	Captures supply, demand and trust in one figure
Academy	Graduate placement rate	The promise we make, so measure the promise
Delivery	On time delivery against the scoped date	Integrity made measurable
Brand	Inbound enquiries per month	Whether the content plan is working

16. What we are deliberately not doing yet

Naming this prevents drift, and tells the content strategist what not to promise.

- Not expanding outside Nigeria until the delivery constraint in section 14 is relieved.
- Not adding a seventh service line. Six is already wide for our size.
- Not competing on price.
- Not building new products until an existing one pays for itself.

PART IV: REPRESENTING FSLABS

17. The pitch, at three lengths

The short version, when someone asks what you do:

FSLabs is a Nigerian technology and cybersecurity company. We build software, secure systems, train engineers, and run our own products.

The medium version, with the hook:

FSLabs is a technology and cybersecurity company in Lagos. We do software development, security, cloud and data work. Unlike most firms, both founders work directly on every project, so nothing gets handed to junior contractors. We also build our own products, like TailorNow, and we train engineers through FSLabs Academy.

The long version, the one that wins a meeting:

Most technology firms sell you senior people and deliver junior ones. The people who won the pitch

disappear after kick off, and the work goes to whoever is free. That gap is where projects die.

FSLabs is built to remove it. We are a company of two founders. Samuel on the technical side,

cybersecurity and full stack. Akinbayo on strategy and delivery. Both of us are on every engagement.

Six service lines: software, cybersecurity, IT consulting, tech outsourcing, cloud, and data.

We work in four stages: Brief, Scope, Build, Deliver. We will not scope a timeline we do not believe, and we report real progress rather than status theatre. What you get at the end works, is

documented, and is ready for production. That is the standard we hold ourselves to.

And we do not only consult. We build and run our own products: a fashion marketplace with payments

and logistics, an HR and payroll platform, an exchange. So when we say we can build something, we

can point at it. We also run an academy training engineers, which is how we grow without lowering

the bar.

18. How to defend the company

You will get these objections. Have the answer ready. Never bluff, because every answer below is true.

"You are only two people. Can you actually handle our project?"

That is exactly why the work gets done properly. You are not a small account to us, and you are never

handed to someone junior. Where we need extra capacity we bring in vetted people, often our own

Academy graduates, but the founders stay accountable for delivery. If a project is genuinely beyond

what we can do well, we will tell you during Scope rather than take your money.

"You are new. What is your track record?"

Look at what we run ourselves. TailorNow is a live marketplace handling payments, split settlement to vendors, and delivery logistics. We built an HR and payroll platform holding real employee and salary data. And an exchange processing requests in about thirty minutes. Most firms our size have a portfolio of other people's brochure sites. We have production systems we operate ourselves.

"Why you instead of a big firm?"

With a big firm you get their process and their second team. With us you get both founders and no layers. We are faster, we are accountable, and we will tell you no. If you need a thousand person global rollout, use them. If you need something built properly by people who answer the phone, use us.

"Why should we trust a Nigerian firm with this?"

Because we are held to the same standard as anyone else, and we have chosen to be. Security from day one, documented delivery, honest timelines. Being local is an advantage: we understand Nigerian payments, Nigerian regulation and Nigerian users in a way an offshore team does not. And we are in the same time zone as your business.

"A freelancer quoted me a fraction of that."

They probably will build something. The question is what happens in month six, when it needs to scale, when it gets attacked, and when the freelancer has moved on and left no documentation. We are not the cheapest and we do not try to be. We are the option where it still works next year.

"Is our data safe with you?"

Security is our founder's own discipline, not a subcontracted extra. We do penetration testing and security audits as a service line. We build secure from day one rather than bolting it on at the end.

We have a written rule that client code and data never goes into third party AI tools. And what we find on your systems never leaves FSLabs.

"What if something happens to one of you?"

Fair question, and it is why the Academy and our vetted bench exist. We are deliberately building capacity beyond the two of us. Everything we deliver is documented, so nothing lives only in someone's head. That is part of why documentation is in our definition of finished.

"Can you deliver on time?"

We scope timelines we believe, which sometimes means quoting longer than you would like. If something is going to slip you hear it the moment we know, not the week it is due. Ask us for a date we cannot hit and we will say so.

If you do not know the answer

Say so, and say what happens next. *"I do not want to guess at that. Let me get you a proper answer from Samuel today."* That is a stronger answer than a confident wrong one, and it is what Integrity means in practice.

19. How we sound: voice guide

For the content strategist, and for anyone writing anything with our name on it.

We sound like a senior engineer who respects your time. Direct, specific, calm. Confident without swagger. We make claims we can back, and we name real things.

DO	DON'T
Short sentences. Concrete nouns.	Long paragraphs of adjectives.
Name the actual thing: "split settlement to the tailor's bank account"	Vague benefit language: "seamless payment experiences"
Say what we did and what happened	Say we are "passionate about excellence"
Admit limits: "we do not do X"	Imply we do everything
Active voice. "We built", "we found", "we fixed"	"Solutions were delivered"
Nigerian context, stated plainly	Pretending to be an American firm

Words that are ours: execution, standard, accountable, documented, secure from day one, no status theatre, both founders, works in the real world.

Phrases to avoid: cutting edge, synergy, revolutionary, game changing, one stop shop, passionate about, at the end of the day, and *leverage* used as a verb. Also *world class* as an empty adjective, though the mission uses it as a commitment, which is different.

On the tagline: "Your Vision. Our Execution." is the line. Do not rewrite it, extend it, or make variants of it.

20. Content pillars

Five pillars, each mapping to an audience in section 12 and a priority in section 14. The first two carry the most weight, because they serve the two priority service lines.

1. Proof of delivery (*enterprise, Services priority*) Teardowns of our own products, built in public. How TailorNow's split settlement works. How we handled a real production problem. Nothing sells a services firm like visible competence.

2. Security literacy (*enterprise, Cybersecurity priority*) Plain explanations of the threats Nigerian businesses actually face. What a penetration test finds. What data protection compliance requires in practice. This positions our highest margin and most repeatable line, and Samuel is genuinely credentialed to author it.

3. Careers in tech, honestly (*students, Academy priority*) What it actually takes to get hired. Graduate stories and where they ended up. Portfolio project walkthroughs. The point to press: taught by engineers who ship, with placement outcomes we are willing to publish.

4. Digitisation for SMEs (*SME, Products priority*) Moving payroll off spreadsheets. What manual attendance tracking really costs. Aimed squarely at the HR and Payroll platform's buyer.

5. The FSLabs way (*everyone, brand*) Both founders on every project. Why we scope honestly. Why documentation is part of finished. This is the pillar that makes the other four believable, and the one nobody else can copy.

What the strategist needs from the founders

- The current quarterly targets behind the priorities in section 14.
- Named client stories we have written permission to publish.
- Whatever traction numbers we are willing to state publicly.
- Access to Samuel for technical authoring. Pillars 1 and 2 need his voice, and they are the two that convert enterprise buyers.

21. Rules and boundaries

These are not negotiable. The Staff Policy sets them out in full.

- **FSLabs is FSLabs.** Never present another company, a client's or anyone else's, as part of FSLabs, as a sister brand, or as one of our products. Our portfolio is TailorNow, the HR and Payroll platform, and FSLabs Exchange. Nothing else.
 - **A product is not the company.** TailorNow is a product of FSLabs. "The company" means FSLabs.
 - **Never name a client** in a deck, on social media, in a portfolio, or in conversation outside FSLabs, without confirmed written permission.
 - **Client code, client pricing and our internal delivery economics stay inside FSLabs.**
 - **Security findings never leave.** What we find on a client's systems is theirs and ours, nobody else's.
 - **Client data never goes into third party AI tools.** No exceptions without written approval from Samuel.
 - **No timeline commitments without Akinbayo.**
 - **Naming:** FSLabs, one word. The company is Folub and Samuel Labs.
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PART V: JOINING FSLABS

22. Your first week

Day 1. Understand the company. Read this handbook end to end, then read the Staff Policy. Visit fslabs.tech and read every page as a client would.

Day 2. Understand the products. Use TailorNow as a customer. Click through the HR platform. Try the Exchange flow. You cannot represent what you have not used.

Day 3. Understand the work. Sit with your founder contact. Get the access your role needs. Read the codebase or the client material relevant to you.

Day 4. Understand the standard. Go through sections 5, 7 and 18 with a founder. Practise the medium pitch out loud until it stops sounding rehearsed.

Day 5. Contribute. Ship something small. It will be reviewed against section 5, not against effort.

By the end of week one you should be able to

- ☐ Say what FSLabs is in one sentence, without notes
- ☐ Name all six service lines
- ☐ Name our three products and what each one does
- ☐ Explain the four stage process, and why "no status theatre" matters
- ☐ State the delivery standard: works, documented, ready for the real world
- ☐ Answer at least three of the objections in section 18 convincingly
- ☐ Know what you must never say or share
- ☐ Know the rule on client data and AI tools, and who to ask when unsure
- ☐ Know who to call when something breaks, and that it is both founders at once
- ☐ Know which founder to go to for what

23. Who to go to

FOR	GO TO
Architecture, security, technical decisions, code review	Adeseko Samuel
Clients, scope, pricing, timelines, partnerships, anything commercial	Akinbayo

FOR	GO TO
Something has broken or may have been breached	Both founders, immediately, whatever the hour
Anything you are unsure about	Ask early, either founder. Both are on every project, so use that.

General enquiries reach us at **folubandsamuel@fslabs.tech**, and the promise on our contact form is a response within 24 hours.

Companion documents

DOCUMENT	WHAT IT COVERS
<code>STAFF_POLICY.md</code>	Hours, leave, pay and commission, client data and AI rules, device security, who owns the work, incident escalation, joining and leaving
<code>ABOUT_FSLABS.md</code>	Shorter company overview, the version to hand to someone outside the team
<code>partnerships/summit-partnership-brief.md</code>	The five organisations met at the summit, our offer and ask for each

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Version 1.0. This document is only useful if it is accurate and used. If something here is wrong, out of date, or does not match how we actually work, say so and it gets changed.